

Sony Ericsson W800i



In the wake of Apple iPod's phenomenal success it was but natural for Sony to revive its once-iconic 'Walkman' brand in some form or other. The W800i from Sony-Ericsson (SE) is the first cell phone to sport the 'Walkman' logo and holds a lot of promise.

Weighing just 99 grams and measuring 100 x 47 x 21 mm, the W800i is light and compact; but don't be fooled by its diminutive size, for it packs some mean features.

The 1.8-inch, 262K colour screen is bright and crystal clear. The 176 x 220 pixel screen renders colours vividly and is a good aide for playing games or browsing through photos.

The joystick and the keypad on the W800i are good—SMS gurus will love it! The UI is pretty much unchanged and retains the same old charm.

The W800i comes with a classy 2 mp digicam—the same as on the K750i. On the phone side, the W800i is graced with GPRS, High Speed Circuit Switched Data, and offers tri-band support but no EDGE.

For short range communication

Bluetooth, Infrared and USB 1.1 port is offered. The phone comes with 38 MB of internal memory and a Memory Stick Duo slot which can be used with the bundled 512 MB card. Java 2.0 support means you can make good use of that memory.

W800i can be used as a phone or media player only—the media player mode increases battery life. SE has significantly improved the audio quality on the W800i and when coupled with the bundled Sony Fontopia ear buds, this cell can match any standalone MP3 player.

The player supports MP3 and AAC playback, but no support for DRM protected files such as those downloaded from iTunes or Napster.

One good thing SE has done is to include a standard 3.5 mm jack via the headset, which allows you to connect any earphone set to the phone or connect the phone to a Hi-Fi for heart thumping sound. The W800i in Media Player mode can playback audio for about 18 hours before the battery runs out—more than enough.

Priced at Rs 25,000 the W800i is sensibly priced. Our verdict: have money, buy!

Sony-Ericsson K750i

The K750i is stylish, but not overtly so, making it a good phone for executives. The buttons have decent tactile feedback, but the five-way joystick is too sensitive and results in navigation errors—until you get used to it!

The 2 mp camera is perhaps its best feature and also has a decent flash. There are various digital camera options such as 4X zoom, Macro mode, Night mode, a cool Panorama mode for shooting wide scenes, and even a Burst mode for capturing four shots in quick succession.

In movie mode, you have the option of either shooting for MMS or high-quality video. The autofocus feature with the 2 MP camera is something every other manufacturer should try and emulate. Overall, the camera is excellent.

Special controls include a media button on the left, which launches either FM or your media player. On the right are volume controls that double up as zoom controls when in camera mode and the shutter button to click!

Above the joystick is an application button that gives you quick

access to various functions.

The speaker is quite low and can hardly be heard on our noisy streets and coupled with a mild vibrator, you are sure to miss a few calls if it's in your pocket. You cannot listen to FM without plugging in the bundled handsfree, and you cannot set the phone to ring both via the external speaker as well as in the handsfree earphones—only when set to silent mode does it ring in-ear!

Bluetooth, GPRS, Infrared, and the bundled USB cable are the various modes of short range communication. The K750i is equipped with 32 MB of internal memory and a 64 MB Memory Stick Duo (MSD) is bundled with the package—you can get as much as 2 GB of space using the MSD slot!

Overall, the phone is great to use, has tons of functions, a great camera and excellent battery life of about three days at normal usage.

At Rs 19,995, the K750i is appropriately priced and makes for a great phone for all occasions.

